

GoNow

Urban Mobility App for Quito's Public Transport

Role	UX/UI Designer (solo project)
Tools	Figma · User Interviews · User Flows
Type	Personal / Portfolio Project
Year	2025
Platform	Mobile — iOS & Android
Portfolio	behance.net/gallery/216556661/UI-UX-Movility-App-GONOW

01 OVERVIEW

GoNow is a mobile application designed to improve the public transport experience for residents of Quito, Ecuador. The app centralizes route planning, real-time transport information, digital payments, and personal safety features into a single, intuitive platform — addressing the fragmented and stressful reality of daily urban commuting.

02 PROBLEM STATEMENT

Quito's public transport system is used daily by thousands of residents, yet the experience remains largely analog and fragmented. Users face three core friction points:

■ Safety Passengers — especially women and students — reported feeling unsafe during trips. No emergency mechanism exists within any transport app.	■ Route Planning Finding the right bus, combination, or stop requires local knowledge or trial and error. No single source of real-time route info.	■ Payment Cash-only or complex payment methods slow boarding, increase exposure to theft, and create friction at every trip.
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03 RESEARCH

I conducted user interviews with regular public transport passengers in Quito to identify their primary pain points and unmet needs. The research focused on understanding real behaviors, not assumed ones.

KEY FINDINGS

- **Safety was the #1 concern** — the most frequently mentioned pain point across all interviews. Users described incidents of harassment, theft, and the lack of any emergency resource during transit.
- Route uncertainty caused daily stress — passengers often didn't know which bus to take or whether a connection would be available on time.
- Payment friction was a consistent frustration — cash dependency made passengers vulnerable and slowed the boarding process.

"I never know if I'll get home safe. I wish there was something I could press if something happens."

— User interview participant

04 KEY DESIGN DECISIONS

Each major feature was grounded in a research finding. Here are the four decisions that defined the app's direction:

SOS Safety Button

Research clearly showed safety as the primary unmet need. I designed a persistent, one-tap SOS button accessible from any screen — a feature absent from global competitors like Moovit or Google Maps. This became GoNow's primary differentiator.

Unified Navigation Hub

Users needed to switch between route lookup, payment, and safety without cognitive load. I designed a bottom navigation with 4 core sections — Home, Routes, Pay, and Safety — keeping everything within one tap from any context in the app.

Simplified Payment Flow

The goal was to reduce digital payment to under 3 steps. I mapped the current cash-based journey (queue → boarding → change) and replaced it with a QR-tap system accessible directly from the home screen.

Accessible Visual System

Quito's transport users span all ages. I chose a high-contrast color palette with clear iconography to ensure usability across demographics, including low-literacy users and older adults.

05 DESIGN PROCESS

The project followed a user-centered design process from discovery to high-fidelity prototype:

- 1 User Research** — Conducted interviews with Quito transport users to identify pain points and unmet needs.
 - 2 Problem Definition** — Synthesized research into 3 core problem areas: safety, route planning, and payment.
 - 3 User Personas** — Built personas representing the primary user archetypes: daily student commuter, working adult, and occasional user.
 - 4 Information Architecture** — Designed the app structure and navigation hierarchy based on task frequency and user mental models.
 - 5 User Flows** — Mapped end-to-end flows for each core task: plan a route, make a payment, and trigger SOS.
 - 6 Wireframes** — Designed low-fidelity screens to validate layout and flow before investing in visual design.
 - 7 High-Fidelity UI** — Built 10–20 polished screens in Figma with a consistent component system.
 - 8 Feedback & Iteration** — Presented the prototype for review with a design mentor and iterated based on feedback.
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06 OUTCOME & LEARNINGS

Fully functional prototype

10–20 screens covering all core user flows, navigable and shareable via Figma.

Safety-first differentiator

The SOS feature positioned GoNow distinctly against existing global transport apps in the Quito context.

Validated design decisions

Prototype reviewed and validated with design feedback from an experienced mentor.

Published portfolio case

Project published on Behance as a documented UX case study.

MAIN LEARNING

The biggest insight from GoNow was that safety isn't a secondary feature — for many urban transport users, it's the primary reason they would switch apps. Starting from real interviews (rather than assumptions) led to a design decision that none of the major competitors had made in this market.
